CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 5: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why were mahajanapadas frequently at war? 1

(a) peace treaties
(b) no kings
(c) competition for land, resources and power
(d) no resources

2. Which characteristic of the Second Urbanisation shows continuity with the First? 1

(a) iron use **(b)** Buddhism
(c) trade and craft production **(d)** coins

3. Why might a king prefer taxes in coin rather than in kind? 1

(a) harder to count **(b)** cannot be used
(c) easier to store and spend **(d)** spoils quickly

4. Which feature shows the persistence of inequality in cities? 1

(a) same houses **(b)** no walls
(c) same goods **(d)** differences in houses and goods

5. How does the use of the moat relate to urban safety? 1

(a) creates a barrier to attackers **(b)** helps farming
(c) increases floods **(d)** helps trade

6. Which situation shows the effect of food surplus? 1

(a) growth of specialist crafts **(b)** fall of cities
(c) no trade **(d)** no coins

7. What does the shift from janapada to mahajanapada indicate? 1

(a) decline of states **(b)** decline of kings
(c) decline of cities **(d)** consolidation of territory and power

8. Why do historians treat literary descriptions of cities cautiously? 1

(a) they never exist **(b)** they are drawings
(c) they may exaggerate or reflect ideals **(d)** they are always accurate

9. **Assertion (A):** The first Indian coins were made of paper. 1
Reason (R): They were called punch-marked coins.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The ruler's main income in early states came from taxes or revenue. 1
Reason (R): Taxes were collected from farmers, traders and craftsmen.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did iron change warfare? 2

12. Why do some cities survive for millennia? 2

13. Why did kings build forts? 2

14. Why did inequality grow? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Examine how trade routes and cities were interdependent. 3

16. Discuss the role of guilds in urban life. 3

17. Evaluate how a mint and coins benefit rulers and traders. 3

OR

Compare the roles of kings and assemblies. 3

18. Examine the challenge of reconstructing the past from limited evidence. 3

OR

Examine the continuities between the First and Second Urbanisations. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** In the republic of Vajji, important decisions were not taken by one king. A group of leaders met in an assembly, discussed matters and decided together. Neighbouring Magadha, however, was ruled by a monarch who commanded a growing army. 5
(i) Name one republic mahajanapada.
(ii) By whom were decisions taken in a republic?
(iii) Which neighbouring state was ruled by a king?
(iv) Explain one difference between the two types of rule.

20. Compare the First and Second Urbanisations in technology, planning and society. 5

OR

Evaluate the argument that the mahajanapadas show early experiments in democracy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks